

AMRITA

hiamrita@gmail.com | New Delhi

ORCID: [0009-0007-2573-7809](#) | [Google Scholar](#) | [Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

ACADEMIC PROFILE

Qualitative and mixed-methods researcher trained in design, studying how people in India live with everyday machines and technological objects: the care they give them, how they explain it when machines fail, and how place, language and ability shape their accounts. Methods: in-depth interviews in Hindi and English, photo and scenario-based elicitation, thematic analysis, digital ethnography, field research with artisans, and surveys.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Qualitative research methodology, especially interviews that work with and through objects; how people come to understand, care for and live with everyday machines and technological objects; and mixed-methods designs that pair interviews with surveys across languages, places and abilities.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design (Fashion Communication)

2020 – 2024 | Patna, India

[National Institute of Fashion Technology \(NIFT\), India](#)

- Final CGPA: 8.3/10 | **All-India Rank 878**, NIFT Entrance Exam
- Final-year industry project: *Festive Playbook*, with Myntra.
- Select coursework: Design Research (crafts-based case studies); Design Methodology for Fashion; Introduction to AI; Interface Design (UI); Semiotics and Letter Forms. [Transcripts](#)

Associate in Applied Science (AAS), Advertising and Marketing Communications

2022 – 2023 | New York, USA

[Fashion Institute of Technology \(FIT\), New York USA](#)

- Final GPA: 3.09/4.0 | **All-India Rank 1** in NIFT's selection for this dual-degree exchange
- Internship (CPT) at M&S Schmalberg, New York.
- Select coursework: Research Methods in Integrated Marketing Communications; Multimedia Computing; Mass Communications. [Transcripts](#)

PREPRINTS / MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

[Making Sense of Machines](#)

08/2026

Ritualized Care, Agency Attribution, and Failure Interpretation in Human-Automation Encounters in India

Full manuscript submitted to *Technology in Society*. [Poster](#) submitted to India HCI 2026.

- Designed and ran a mixed-methods study: a survey of 156 adults and in-depth interviews with 21 people across urban and rural India, in Hindi and English, using photos and short scenarios as prompts, about how they care for their machines and how they explain it when machines fail.
- 96% reported some form of machine care, such as blessing a new vehicle or honoring tools during Vishwakarma Puja (an annual festival for tools and machines). When a vehicle failed and then restarted on its own, 62% also chose a reason about care or meaning, such as having neglected it or the failure being a warning sign.
- Against the study's starting assumption that people would describe machines as living things, interviewees described their care as practical upkeep, not a belief that machines are conscious. Proposes an early framework for how such care shapes trust in machines and how people explain failures.

[Neuro-Inclusive Generative AI](#)

06/2026

Cognitive Barriers, Coping Strategies, and Design Patterns in Prompt-Based Creative Tools

Submitted to Annual Conference of Cognitive Science (ACCS 2026), University of Hyderabad

- A structured review of research from 2020 to 2026 on why prompt-based AI image tools can be hard to use for people with ADHD, autism, dyslexia, and related cognitive differences.
- Identified four barriers: keeping track of long prompts and settings, planning repeated rounds of revision, dense text-heavy screens, and hidden prompting rules that make it hard to tell why an image came out wrong.
- Sorted every design recommendation by strength of evidence; most rest on related studies or inference, and no reviewed study tested an AI image tool with neurodivergent users.

Beyond the Dashboard

2026

*Ambient Intent Cues for Human-Automation Interaction***Accepted** (~17% acceptance rate) for publication in *Proceedings of India HCI 2026*, ACM Digital Library.

- Proposes a framework for how machines that work around people without a screen, such as delivery robots, self-driving vehicles, and smart homes, can show what they are doing or about to do through light, sound, movement, vibration, and timing, with a four-stage model that traces each cue from the machine's state to how a person reads it and responds.

Dressed for the Festival, Made for the Landfill

2026

*Dark Patterns, Cultural Appropriation, and Greenwashing in Indian Fashion E-Commerce***Accepted** for presentation at Humanizing Work and Work Environment 2026 (HWWE 2026), UPES School of Design, Dehradun (**Springer proceedings**, camera-ready submitted).

- A conceptual paper, informed by fieldwork with Sikki grass weavers in Bihar, arguing that Indian fashion sites use festival and craft imagery to rush people into buying cheap, mass-produced clothing that looks eco-friendly. Proposes three new concepts linking dark patterns (design tricks that pressure buyers, like countdown timers), cultural appropriation, and greenwashing.

Festivity, E-Commerce, and Cultural Appropriateness

2027

Full paper accepted for presentation at Fashion as a Tool for Social Change (FTSC 2027), Woxsen University, as first author with **Prof. Ragini Ranjana**, NIFT Patna; under review for *Textile: Cloth and Culture* or a Scopus-indexed **Springer** volume.

- Used digital ethnography to study how three Indian fashion platforms show five traditional crafts at festival time: **75 product-page screenshots** from their websites and **81** from nine festive Instagram campaigns.
- No product page named the artisan or showed an official craft mark, though all five crafts are legally registered, and printed fabric was often sold under craft names such as Bandhani (a hand tie-dye craft).

SELECTED ACADEMIC DESIGN RESEARCH PROJECTS (2022–2024)

Craft Research Documentation on Sikki Grass

2022

Field Documentation / Cultural Research | Faculty mentor: Mr. Mohammad Shadab Sami, NIFT Patna

- Spent several days in Raiyam West village, Bihar, interviewing three generations of one artisan family and five more women artisans; recorded each artisan's household role, craft, and registration date.
- Documented 10 named techniques of Sikki (a grass-weaving craft) stitch by stitch; compared the community's oral history with the craft's Geographical Indication (GI) registration.
- Set the fieldwork against national export data (India's handmade exports grew from \$3.5B to \$4.3B in one year); designed a small product brand with logo and packaging.

Festive Playbook — Myntra

2024

UI-UX, E-commerce, Cultural Design Strategy | Academic mentor: Mr. Kumar Vikas, NIFT Patna

- Researched 30 Indian festivals and compared how people celebrate them today with how earlier generations did, including the role of shopping and social media.
- Informed Myntra's live 2024 festive campaigns (storefront, imagery, and copy); adopted by five teams, including Category, Curation, and Copy.
- Directed a festival photoshoot used across the live campaigns.

Immersive Retail Experience Design

2023

Academic AR/VR Experience Design | Faculty mentor: Ms. Monika, NIFT Patna

- Followed a four-step process (research, trend synthesis, 3D modeling, prototyping) for three concepts based on crafts from Bihar: Sujani embroidery, Madhubani art, and Bhagalpuri silk.
- Modeled four AR/VR shopping concepts in Blender, based on real retail tech such as FX Mirror and GU's Style Creator Stand, including an AR map that pins Sujani embroidery to its village of origin.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teach For India

10/2024 – 01/2025

School Design Cohort Member

Took part in an intensive school-design program on how ordinary classrooms could give students more control over their learning, with coursework in alternative schooling models and curriculum prototyping.

Robin Hood Army

2021 – 2022 | Delhi, India

Volunteer Educator

Taught children with limited access to formal schooling; led 100+ community food distribution drives.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Associate Brand Designer

09/2025 – Present | Noida, India

Zinnia

- Design brand and marketing materials for an insurance software company that sells to businesses (B2B SaaS), working with U.S.-based teams on global brand projects.
- Turn complex enterprise technology into clear visuals for product, marketing, and content teams.

Graphic Designer

09/2024 – 08/2025 | Kolkata, India

Bombaim

- Designed digital and print ads, campaigns, and brand stories for a luxury multi-brand retailer.

Creative Design Intern

01/2024 – 04/2024 | Bangalore, India

Myntra

- Worked with the Store, Category, Brands, UX, Curation, and Copy teams on research and UI design.
- Helped shape culturally grounded festive shopping experiences, which fed into the Festive Playbook.

Marketing Strategist Intern

06/2023 – 09/2023 | New York, USA

M&S Schmalberg

- Researched market trends and competitors for a heritage fabric-flower maker to support product presentation, packaging, and brand communication.

AWARDS, LEADERSHIP, AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Aspire Leaders Program

2025

Aspire Institute

Completed all stages of the 2025 program, with coursework in leadership, critical thinking, communication, and social impact. Received the Academic Advancement Grant.

Winner, Visual Merchandising

2021

WorldSkills India

Represented Delhi at the WorldSkills India national competition; honored by the Chief Minister and Deputy Chief Minister of Delhi and officials of the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC).

RESEARCH METHODS, TOOLS, AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Qualitative Research

In-depth interviews in Hindi and English; thematic analysis; vignette and photo elicitation; digital ethnography; visual and semiotic analysis; narrative review; literature synthesis.

Survey & Mixed-Methods Research

Survey design; scenario and photo-based questions; sampling across metro, smaller-town and semi-rural sites; descriptive analysis in Excel; combining survey and interview findings; user research; accessibility analysis.

Fieldwork & Elicitation

Field research with artisan communities; interviews across three generations of one artisan family; comparing oral history with official craft records; craft documentation; focus-group design.

Research and Design Tools

Google Forms and Excel (survey design and analysis); interview transcription tools; Figma; Adobe Creative Cloud; generative AI tools (Midjourney, Runway ML, Claude, OpenAI API).

CERTIFICATES AND ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Selected Professional Training: Research Writing with AI Tools & Presentation Design; UX Research; Generative AI Essentials; AR/VR Fundamentals; Oxford Climate Change Course; Figma; Adobe Creative Cloud; Leadership; Communication.